

OCCUPANCY QUICK REFERENCE CARD

(Laminated and Pocket-Sized)

OCCUPIED INDICATORS (Need 2+ for Determination)

- ✓ **Vehicle(s)** in driveway with current registration visible
- ✓ **Porch/yard furniture** (not covered, appears in use)
- ✓ **Mail being collected** (mailbox empty or minimal mail)
- ✓ **Utilities on** (lights visible, condensation on meter)
- ✓ **Curtains/blinds maintained** (open/closed, clean)
- ✓ **Lawn maintenance** (grass cut, hedges trimmed)
- ✓ **Seasonal decorations** (appropriate to current season)
- ✓ **Pet supplies visible** (dog house, bowls, toys)
- ✓ **Children's toys in yard** (bikes, play equipment)
- ✓ **Occupant present** (you see/speak with them)

VACANT INDICATORS (Need 2+ for Determination)

- ✓ **Accumulated mail** (stack at door, overflowing mailbox)
- ✓ **Yellow phone books stacked** at door (classic vacant sign)
- ✓ **Overgrown grass/weeds** (knee-high or higher)
- ✓ **Interior visible showing empty** (no furniture)
- ✓ **Utilities off** (meter stopped, no condensation)
- ✓ **Notice postings** (foreclosure, utility shut-off, code violation)
- ✓ **Boarded windows/doors**
- ✓ **Winterization stickers/tags**
- ✓ **Debris accumulation** (leaves in gutters, yard unkempt)
- ✓ **No curtains/blinds** (windows bare)

PHOTO REQUIREMENTS BY STATUS

Status	Minimum Photos	Required Set
OCCUPIED (Exterior)	10-12	• 6-Angle Rule (Front, Number, Street Sign, Neighborhood, Left, Right) • 2 Occupancy Indicators (close-ups) • Garage (if present) • Any signs/violations
VACANT (Exterior)	15-20	• 6-Angle Rule • Right Side, Left Side, Rear • Proof of Vacancy (empty interior visible) • 2+ Vacancy Indicators • Utility Meters
INTERIOR (Authorized)	25-40	• All Exterior requirements PLUS: • Every room (Living, Kitchen, Bedrooms, Bathrooms) • Appliances, Hot Water Heater, Furnace, Thermostat • Inside toilet bowls

COMMON MISTAKES TO AVOID

- **Inferring without evidence** - Never guess occupancy. Document observable facts only.
- **Missing side/rear on vacant** - Vacant requires Right/Left/Rear + Proof of Vacancy.
- **No occupancy indicators for occupied** - Need 2+ indicators, not just 6-Angle Rule.
- **Photos through glass** - NEVER shoot through windows for "proof of vacancy."
- **Notes contradict photos** - If notes say occupied but photos show empty = rejection.